

Human ideas. Shared possibilities.

A hands-on exploration of emerging technology and storytelling
August 29, 2026 | El Segundo, California



Better Youth GenJam participants and facilitator at the close of the August workshop. Photo: Jonathan Waas.

The opportunity

Better Youth prepares foster and system-impacted young people for opportunities in the creative economy through mentoring and media arts education. Its team wanted to explore how emerging technology could fit into a creative process while keeping human ideas, choices, and values at the center.

AI Film Academy facilitated an adult pilot GenJam: a six-hour, team-based workshop built around discussion, live demonstrations, and hands-on creative exploration. Participants formed teams and developed visual story ideas together.

Inside the experience



Team members experiment with visual storytelling together. Photo: Jonathan Waas.

- Start with a human idea. Story prompts gave teams a shared creative starting point.
- Make the idea visible. The workshop introduced character references, storyboarding, and visual generation within a larger filmmaking process.
- Create together. Teams explored options at their laptops, with live facilitation and feedback throughout the room.
- Discuss what the tools make possible. The session created space for questions, creative choices, and reflection.

What the pilot demonstrated

The event documentation shows active team discussion, work with character and storyboard imagery, hands-on coaching, and shared review of visuals. These are tangible examples of how an organization can turn a conversation about emerging technology into a shared creative experience.

The August pilot provides a foundation for the next Better Youth session, planned for September 19. The next workshop can build on this experience through a full GenJam or a focused character-design and storyboarding session.

Bring the experience to your organization

GenJams help organizations explore emerging technology through a facilitated creative challenge. Each engagement can be shaped around the group, learning goals, and time available.

Plan a workshop with AI Film Academy

Better Youth: mission and programs